What has also added to the enigma and mystique of Bhagat Singh is that his earlier years are difficult to fathom with any degree of certainty. This is largely due to his own actions. He had decided to remain secretive and elusive before his arrest. This was consistent with the policy of the HSRA. Its members were required to be informed of 'actions' purely on a need-to-know basis. Party plans were communicated only to members of the inner circle. In so conducting itself, the HSRA had learned much from the experience of the Kakori Conspiracy Case, which involved the trial of members of the Hindustan Republication Association ('HRA'), an armed revolutionary organization of India established in 1924, which had the aim of establishing a 'Federated Republic of the United States of India'. In that case, it had been the evidence of three former members that had led directly to the capture and conviction of members of key importance. The HSRA was determined not to make the same mistake.

Indeed, after his first arrest in May 1927, following the Dussehra Bomb Case, Bhagat Singh had come under pressure to betray his comrades and to become a government witness, which is described in the judgment itself as an 'approver'. He had fallen under suspicion for two reasons. First, he was 'the nephew of the notorious Ajit Singh'.[4] Second, he had known connections with a number of left-wing youth movements. These included, in particular, the Naujawan Bharat Sabha. The Bureau of Intelligence described this organization as having 'adopted as the ideal the inculcation of revolutionary sentiments and of disloyalty to the government'.[5] Once again, therefore, a fear of disloyalty, spurred on by an attraction of violent communist revolution amongst the youth, was officialdom's impending and ever present nightmare from which it could not break free.

But the authorities were wasting their time. They could not induce Bhagat Singh into becoming a turncoat. 'Bhagat Singh,' as Kama Maclean observes, 'was contemptuous of the offer of freedom and reward in return for a statement.'[6] This early political precocity is significant. So committed was he in the defence of his ideals that it remained with him throughout, from his trial through to his ultimate execution. His steadfastness was consistent with the ethos of the HSRA. As an organization, the HSRA had